



## MEDICAL MIRACLE

**The National** Medical Commission has said that foreign medical graduates with incomplete internships due to “compelling situations” beyond their control, such as the Covid-19 pandemic and war, are eligible to complete their internships in India without any fees. That is good news for the lakhs of medical students forced to flee from war-torn Ukraine.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

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## METaverse BECKONS

**The global** metaverse revenue opportunity could approach \$800 billion in 2024, and Indian IT companies are piling on to it. Infosys introduced a metaverse foundry with over 100 ready-to-use cases and templates to ease enterprises’ exploration of the metaverse. Tech Mahindra will drive commerce in the metaverse by leveraging network and infrastructure capabilities along with digital tech capabilities. And TCS is investing in proofs of concept for employee on-boarding and customer experience.

—NIDHI SINGAL



PHOTO BY RACHIT GOSWAMI

## FMCG on Fire

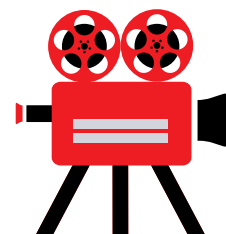
**THE ONGOING war in Ukraine and the consequent supply disruptions have left no room for cooling off in the already heated up daily essentials market in India. While prices of key household items such as soaps, detergents and edible oils are already on fire, with leading players like HUL and Adani Wilmar raising prices repeatedly, prices of packaged goods are set to go up further by 10-20 per cent in the coming weeks. This, however, does not bode well for manufacturers. As they tend to absorb a part of inflated costs, their margins are set to remain under pressure for at least the next two-three months.**

—ARNAB DUTTA

## GAME ON

**India’s multiplex chains** seem to be looking at gaming as a saviour in tough times. After PVR tied up with NODWIN Gaming to create in-cinema Esports live tournaments, the second-largest multiplex chain INOX Leisure has also jumped in. It has tied up with Esports Federation of India (ESFI) to provide a community viewing experience of Esports tournaments on the big screen. Will these moves help the multiplex giants make up for the pandemic’s lost eyeballs and revenue?

—PRERNA LIDHOO



## NO IPO INSURANCE

**The road** ahead for LIC’s IPO is getting bumpier. The Russia-Ukraine conflict shows no sign of abating, the benchmark S&P BSE Sensex is down nearly 11 per cent from last October (till March 10), the IPO market has seen no public issue in the past one month, crude has hit multi-year highs. Consequently, the near-term outlook

for the market is far from positive. All this does not bode well for LIC and more importantly, if the IPO moves to FY23, then the government’s disinvestment target for FY22 of ₹78,000 crore (revised estimate from the earlier ₹1.75 lakh crore) looks set to fall short by a fair bit.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR



PHOTO BY QAMAR SIBTAIN



**CRORE WAGE PAYMENTS PENDING TO MGNREGA WORKERS IN JANUARY 2022, WITH THE LARGEST PENDING PAYMENTS BEING IN WEST BENGAL, UTTAR PRADESH AND RAJASTHAN**